BBarters
Don't be users, be barters.

Negation with Articles

Maîtrisez la négation !

Basic Negation

To negate a verb in present tense, wrap the primary verb with **ne** and **pas**. However, the **ne** part of the negation becomes **n'** if the verb in question is beginning with a vowel or a **mute h**.

Tu parles français. => Tu **ne** parles **pas** français.
J'aime le café. => Je **n'**aime **pas** le café.

Types of Articles

Types of Articles	Examples
Definite article (The)	le – la – l' – les
Indefinite article (A / An)	un – une – des
Partitive article (Some)	du – de la – de l' – des

Negation with Articles

Definite article – When an affirmative sentence has any definite article (le, la, l', les) or any of its contractions (au, aux… ; du, des…), the same article is **retained** in the negative sentence.

Français	English
Il aime **le** voyage. Il n'aime pas **le** voyage.	He likes the journey. He does not like the journey.
Elle étudie **l**'histoire. Elle n'étudie pas **l**'histoire.	She studies History. She does not study History.
Ils vivent **aux** États-Unis. Ils ne vivent pas **aux** États-Unis.	They live in the United States. They do not live in the United States.

Indefinite article – When an affirmative sentence has any indefinite article (un, une, des), it transforms into **de or d'** after pas in the negative sentence (except for "être" and other state-of-being verbs).

Français	English
Il a **des** femmes. Il n'a pas **de** femmes.	He has wives. He does not have wives.
Vous avez **une** grande maison. Vous n'avez pas **de** grande maison.	You have a big house. You do not have a big house.
Marie a **des** amis**.** Marie n'a pas **d'**amis.	Marie has friends. Marie does not have any friends.
Donald mange **un** hamburger. Donald ne mange pas **de** hamburger.	Donald is eating a hamburger. Donald is not eating a hamburger.

Partitive article – Similar to the indefinite article, the partitive article (du, de la, de l', des) transforms into **de** or **d'** after pas (except for "être" and the state-of-being verbs).

Français	English
J'ai de **l'**eau. Je n'ai pas **d'**eau.	I have some water. I do not have water.
Nous mangeons **de la** viande. Nous ne mangeons pas **de** viande.	We are eating meat. We are not eating meat.
John a **de la** patience. John n'a pas **de** patience.	John has patience. John does not have any patience.
J'achète **du** poisson. Je n'achète pas **de** poisson.	I am buying fish. I am not buying any fish.

Note: With the verb **être**, the indefinite and the partitive articles **are retained** after "pas."

Français	English
C'est **de l'**huile d'olive. Ce n'est pas **de l'**huile d'olive.	This is olive oil. This is not olive oil.
Je suis **une** femme d'affaires. Je ne suis pas **une** femme d'affaires.	I am a businesswoman. I am not a businesswoman.
C'est **de l'**eau potable. Ce n'est pas **de l'**eau potable.	It is drinking water. It is not drinking water.
C'est **une** bonne idée. Ce n'est pas **une** bonne idée.	It is a good idea. It is not a good idea.

Expressions of Quantity

Expressions of Quantity	Meaning
Beaucoup de	A lot of
Plein de	Plenty of
Trop de	Too much of
Peu de	A bit of
Une tasse de	A cup of
Assez de	Enough of
Combien de	How many / How much
Une barquette de	A basket of
Une boîte de	A box of
Une bouteille de	A bottle of
Un verre de	A glass of

With expressions of quantity, the partitive article gets omitted. Hence, we don't say beaucoup de l'argent.

Expressions of Quantity	Meaning
Nous avons **beaucoup d'**argent.	We have a lot of money.
J'ai **une bouteille d**'eau.	I have a bottle of water.
Il achète **plein de** livres.	He is buying plenty of books.
Elle veut **une tasse de** café.	She wants a cup of coffee.
Le vendeur vend **une barquette de** fraises.	The seller is selling a basket of strawberries.

Language Expressions

Generally, we do not use articles while using language expressions which take the preposition “de.”

Expressions of Quantity	Examples	Meaning
Avoir besoin de	Nous avons besoin **de** vacances.	We need a vacation.
	Elle a besoin **de** temps.	She needs time.
Avoir envie de	Tout le monde a envie **d'**amour.	Everybody wants love.
	Tu as vraiment envie **de** chocolat.	You really want chocolate.

Note - Whilst referring to a specific object, **de** is followed by the definite article.

Expressions of Quantity	Examples	Meaning
Avoir envie de + definite article + object	Elle a envie **de la** robe de chez la créatrice.	She wants the dress from the designer.
Avoir besoin de + definite article + object	Il a besoin **du** numéro de l’agent de sécurité.	He needs the security guard's number.